

step. The history window might not always be visible but you can enable it by clicking on the Window menu and then on Other Panels > History.

Layers To Organise Elements

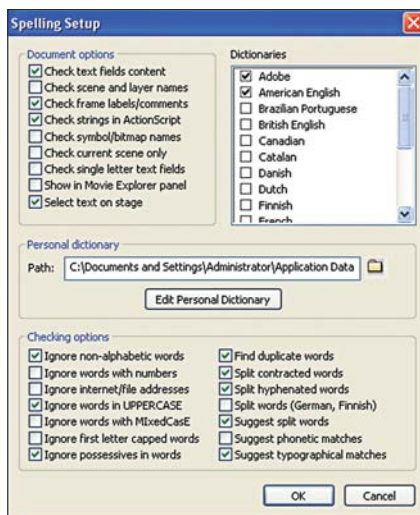
Using layers while designing is useful in grouping elements and making changes to them without any confusion. To add new layers in Flash CS3, right click on the timeline window and click Insert Layer.

Optimising Shapes

Every object in Flash has a number of control points which give it a distinct shape. Sometimes there can be too many redundant points especially in cases where you have used an eraser to erase certain portions of an object. An optimising feature is built into Flash CS3 which can be accessed by first clicking on an object using the Selection tool. Click on Modify > Shape > Optimize. Set a level of smoothing and click OK. If you find the object is losing any serious characteristic shape, then undo the move. It's also a good habit to use the Smooth and Straighten tools from the Main toolbar. They can be used to bring down the number of nodes or make the objects smoother.

Spell Checking

The spell checking feature can help those embarrassing slipups from making their way on to the Internet. Run the spell checking feature by clicking on Text > Check Spelling. You can setup the spell checking feature much better and also

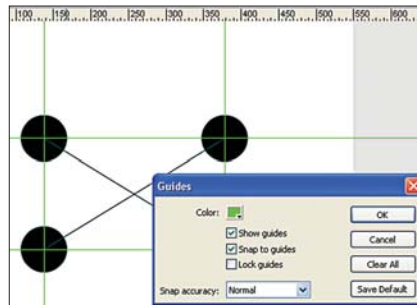


Flash's Spell check is very customisable

specify more dictionaries of other languages and custom dictionaries of your own by clicking on the Text menu and then on Spelling Setup.

Precision Designing

The Snapping, Ruler and Guides feature are there to help create designs accurately with ease. Snapping can be set on by clicking on View >



Guides can make aligning and accurate placing of objects very easy

Snapping. Click on Edit > Snapping in that sub-menu how you would like the mouse pointer to snap to. The Ruler feature is required to be able to set guides which are similar to grids but which can be modified and created as per your needs.

To create a new guide, click on View > Rulers. Once the ruler has been

Quick Shortcuts

Play	[Enter]
Rewind	[Ctrl] + [Alt] + [R]
Move ahead by 1 frame	[.]
Move back by 1 frame	[,]
Insert frame	[F5]
Create blank keyframe	[F6]
Convert to Keyframes	[F7]
Clear keyframes	[Shift] + [F6]
Tools	
Brush	[B]
Pencil	[Y]
Pen	[P]
Paint Bucket Tool	[K]
Eraser	[E]
Insert Symbol	[Ctrl] + [F8]
Move object forward	[Ctrl] + [Up arrow]
Move object backward	[Ctrl] + [Down arrow]
Send object to front	[Ctrl] + [Shift] + [Up arrow]
Send object to bottom	[Ctrl] + [Shift] + [Down arrow]
View	
Zoom in	[Ctrl] + [+]
Zoom out	[Ctrl] + [-]
Set 100% zoom	[Ctrl] + [1]
Show all	[Ctrl] + [3]
Show grid	[Ctrl] + [']
Show guide	[Ctrl] + [;]
Enable/Disable Ruler	[Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Shift] + [R]

enabled, left click on one of the rulers and drag it out where you want a guide line to be set. Do the same steps with the two rulers with as many guide lines as you wish to create. If you wish to remove a guide line, then click on the guide line and drag it out of the window. Make sure you have the snapping feature set to Guides. Now when you move your mouse pointer near a guide it should latch on to them automatically.

Motion And Shape Tweening

The problem with animating one frame after another is that it's very slow to create and it's not perfect so the resulting animation isn't as smooth as expected. There are two features called motion tween and shape tween to counter this problem.

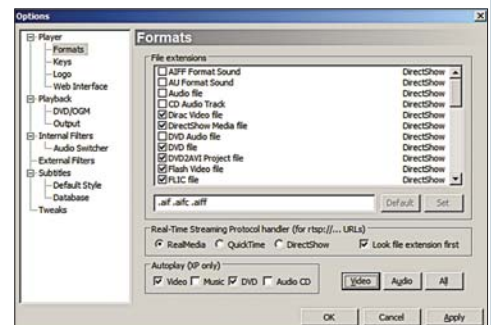
The shape and motion tween feature allow the user to set a starting and ending position or shape for an object. All the frames in between are generated by Flash CS3. To do this, first create the keyframes and place or modify the shape of the objects. Then, click on Insert > Timeline > Create Motion Tween or Create Shape Tween if you modified the shape.

MEDIA PLAYER CLASSIC

Media Player Classic might look like the old Microsoft Windows Media Player 6, but is in fact one of the most used media players around. At around a megabyte in size, the player is much more compact than VLC or any of the others. Let's look at some of the most important and useful features that also make MPC the player of choice for many. We'll be using the last stable release—6.4.9.0. You can find it in one of our CDs or download it for free from <http://sourceforge.net/projects/gulivertk/>.

Make It Default

We've already told you why Media Player Classic is so good. If you want to have Media Player Classic as your



MPC can be made to play back a few selected formats